

NEW AGE EDUCATION

Greetings, my dearest friends, blessed be every one of you here. We are assembled together in order to create truth and light. Tonight's lecture will deal with education in the new age -- the age that is coming, that is pushing into the resistant matter of the old that does not want to yield easily. And yet it must yield. This new age must create, will create human beings of the highest caliber in every respect. A certain percentage of the spirits incarnated is ready for a completely new approach to life -- the approach that you are learning and that you are laboriously working your way through into the depth of your inner being.

As a fundamental prerequisite, the new age education has to make room, above all, for the understanding that you learn from the principles on this path, for the understanding of the human levels of consciousness and the interactions of the various levels. As you perhaps begin to realize, this can be taught to children -- taught not only as theory but as an experience to go through.

Education must be a two-way street. First of all, it must bring out what exists within the higher self -- its uniqueness and its limitless potentials for creativity in all sorts of different ways. Each incarnated individual has its own unique contributions to make to the existing society. These potentialities need to be tapped, a channel for them created in full consciousness of the process. The other approach is to put in the learning from outside, without which such bringing out is hardly possible. This two-fold approach must be considered as an always alternating process. You cannot draw out what is within if there is no knowledge, no concept, if no room is made for the richness of the world that exists in the inner universe. If the focus is not to make room for this richness, if no tuning-in process is made available, then the channel for bringing out the inner potentials will remain untapped. But if you teach this tuning-in process, if you teach that there is another level of consciousness, of awareness, little by little as you learn to do it, so will the child learn to discover the language of the divine reality within. The child will learn to listen, to perceive, and to bring it out.

This does not mean, however, not to learn the fundamental knowledge that all children need to learn in the age just going by, as well as in the new age. But now there is room only for the one, not for the other direction. This alternating approach is what really counts. One must not take the place of the other, they are both important. One must not be cultivated at the expense of the other as mankind so often tends to in all such matters.

If you approach the child with this double purpose, a very different process of learning and education is going to unfold. For the inner voice will be discerned when its laws are understood. The learning of the laws, the pitfalls of the lower self -- so that its own voice can be distinguished -- must become a substantial aspect of the child's curriculum. So there will be a large quota of learning that is concerned with the inner being, with the bringing out of the higher self, with the purification of the lower self, and with a very exact knowledge of the laws that prevail in the discernment of

both, and also in the realization of the existence of the mask self. Education will eliminate masks about to be formed and will start self-purification early. Such is the groundwork for all new age education, learning, and creativity in whatever field.

The fundamental groundwork will be taken up not only by parents -- for there is no guarantee that all parents are sufficiently highly developed to possess this knowledge and are thus equipped to handle this aspect of the child's education; it must therefore also be part of the school curriculum for all ages, starting as early as kindergarten and going into college and university. So a large part of education will deal -- as the fundamental road to learning -- with the realization of the higher self. Intellectual knowledge will then become secondary. Not that it becomes less important or unimportant, but it then can bring fruit. The intellect needs to be trained and used as one of the important tools. For without the intellect grasping and understanding these laws and processes, the personality cannot even begin to approach the road into the inner self. If the mind does not know that there even exists an inner world to find and explore, it cannot ever attempt to go in the right direction, make the proper efforts, remove the obstructions, recognize what is obstruction and what is an aid. So new age education is not only a question of emotional or spiritual education. It is truly a perception and an understanding of lawfulness. Just as there are chemical laws, laws of physics, laws of mathematics for man to understand, so are these laws of the inner world to be learned and understood.

Now there are other aspects about the education to come. For instance, the curiosity of the child must be cultivated so that learning will be intensely interesting and fascinating. Unfortunately this is by no means the case now. On the contrary, the child's innate curiosity is discouraged. Children have from their earliest age millions of questions. You all know that. Usually parents and teachers become annoyed, bored, and impatient. At best they give very insufficient answers, answers that are hardly honest, or answers that fail to take the questions and the questioner seriously.

Now it is extremely important to cultivate this curiosity, for once it is squashed, the learning process becomes a dull "must" that kills the spirit and the life of learning. It can be intrinsically exciting, enjoyable, adventurous, and it often would be if a mass image of boredom would not be attached to it.

Parents should start in the earliest phases of the child's questioning to respect the child and rejoice in the questions brought forth. They do not have to try so hard and pretend to know more than they do. All they have to be is honest and interested. If they really do not know an answer, they should say so, but also tell the child that school will bring all these answers. The child should be encouraged to ask them again and perhaps to make note of them. Or the parents can note them down. The parents can also make a concerted effort of their own to find out meaningful and truthful answers and then come back to the child with these answers. It must be realized that it is the spirit of the child that reaches forth to explore this world in order to master it and fulfill a task in it. Without this curiosity, something dies. So this curiosity is very important. Parents can go to nursery teachers, later to school teachers or other people equipped to answer such questions. They should really make an effort. All questions that a young child has asked will be dealt with later in the curriculum. They may be pointers to the spirit's special inclinations and directions. They should be answered again and again as the child grows older and can take in more.

Schools will know that the spirit ventures out into the earth realm and that curiosity is the sign of the adventurousness that made the entity want to incarnate and fulfill a task. Approached in this way, the material makes learning an exciting process instead of a dull, compelling, boring difficulty that one would like to have over and done with. Learning will become something to look forward to. It will offer many keys to life. It will furnish deeply desired answers to life.

This is very important, my friends, very important for the parents who are here and for the teachers even if you cannot as yet create a new school system, a new educational system, a new curriculum. But just knowing of these approaches and making room in your consciousness for them will give you a new awareness and will create a new climate in your dealings with the growing human being.

The next aspect I wish to talk about in regard to education is what is now for most of you still a difficulty, and that is finding the fine balance between freedom, self-choice -- as I discussed in the last question-and-answer session here -- and self-discipline. Although I discussed this in other contexts, this is equally applicable to learning and education. The freedom to want to learn is important. There should be no whip behind it, if at all possible. This depends greatly, of course, on providing the proper climate by the consciousness of the adult world around. If the adult harbors an image that learning is a hardship, a boring and dull task even if he does not say so, he will affect the child in a similar way. If there is an attitude that assumes that learning and homework are "the price to be paid" before pleasure can begin, it is assumed that the child will hate learning. And then this will be conveyed to the child, and he or she will indeed believe it and eventually find it so even if there would have existed at first a readiness to be interested in it.

The necessity of self-discipline is great. Without it, nothing can be gained or accomplished in life on any level. Freedom, spontaneity on the one hand and self-discipline on the other are not only not mutually exclusive as most people believe, but they are in fact mutually interactive, aiding, interconnected, and interdependent. Since most adults suffer from this duality (that freedom and self-discipline cancel each other out), it is inevitably transferred to the child. This is perhaps not done in so many words but in the climate, in the emotional expression, in the inner consciousness that spreads and affects the child.

In this belief, freedom means to give in to the line of least resistance and thus to become self-destructive. Or, conversely, self-discipline then means the dullness of laborious effort without reward. Now, perhaps most of you, my friends, can begin to see how untrue this is, how unnecessary such artificial divisions are, and how much burden they cause to your soul substance and to your inner consciousness and therefore to your entire life.

You have to free yourself of this misconception on your own path just as parents and teachers also have to do this. They have to learn that, in fact, true freedom with all its joy, with all the liberating self-expression can only exist to the degree that self-discipline exists also. You have to make a very distinct difference between discipline that is chosen by the self and discipline that is imposed by the outside. Discipline imposed by the outside, if we discard tyranny, must only exist where self-discipline is lacking, only when adults or children act destructively to their environment or themselves. As far as children are concerned, self-destructive acts must be discouraged by their elders. As far as adults are concerned, this is hardly possible or desirable, but we shall not go into this topic now.

The concept of freely chosen self-discipline, as opposed to necessary imposed discipline when the former is absent, can be made clear to children with the greatest of ease, without any difficulty whatsoever. A child is very capable of understanding that the outer discipline is a structure that is "waiting in reserve" only. In other words, if the child would not respond to the freedom of learning; if he or she is not willing to understand the necessity of wanting it even if this means occasionally overcoming a resistance, overcoming the temptation to do what seems most pleasurable at the moment; the outwardly imposed discipline is essential for him as well as for the community. If the child can learn to determine for himself, then he has learned a major lesson of life. If he learns self-determination and self-responsibility, if he is guided into this understanding, he has gained a profound substance and foundation. If he can say "yes, I will do homework now and learn my quota so and so many hours a day even though emotionally I prefer to go out and play, because I understand that this will give me later knowledge, strength, security, success -- all the things that I find desirable -- and I choose so freely," he has learned the lesson of real freedom very early in life. And this is indeed possible. Guidance can be very explicitly and implicitly given for this aspect to grow in the child so that self-discipline is freely chosen and outer imposed discipline is no longer necessary. It must always exist as a structure in reserve to be used when needed. For, of course, even in the new age there will be individuals who are not yet developed enough to be capable of understanding what I am saying here, and they will willfully act out in a destructive way -- children as well as adults.

But the time will come (not during your lifetime) when outer laws will no longer exist, when each human being will be governed by his inner law of the divine self and will know what is right for him. He will not kill, steal, harm, or destroy others. But it will not be fear of punishment that would hold him back. And as far as laws not dealing with such crass and obvious infringements are concerned, humanity will then know that there is no rigid rule that applies to everyone alike. Each one will be sufficiently united with his higher self, his conscience and integrity will be sufficiently strong so that he will freely do what is right, what is fair, what is necessary. But he will not do it out of fear of disapproval. He will not be obedient out of guilt and insecurity but will know, "this is right for me," whether it conforms with the general masses or not. He will be able to do so because he will also be free from rebellion against authority and, what is more, free from secret desires to exploit others.

Very few human beings are today anywhere near this point, so the outer structure is necessary for those who need it. Those who do not need it do not require to be told what to do and what not to do. They want to be in truth with the law of God that often is similar to human law, but not always. Children can learn this in very specific ways. For example, topics that have always appeared difficult and dull such as general learning, arithmetic, spelling, history will continue to be taught, of course. In most instances, however, even those topics will be much more interesting with the new approach I mentioned here. For the child is innately curious and wants to know many things. If this is fostered and those subjects approached in that way, much of the tediousness of learning will become obsolete. Nevertheless, there will always be times when inertia and taking the line of least resistance must be overcome until something is really learned. To overcome this threshold, a child can be taught the principles I explain here about the necessity and freedom of self-discipline. This very fundamental understanding of self-discipline as a prerequisite for freedom will be part of the basic education.

So the time will come soon when a child will freely choose self-discipline and do it joyfully because it is his by choice. The whole inner climate of teaching, of educating will be to foster bringing knowledge that the soul of the little one is truly thirsting for. The approach and the consciousness of those who teach is very instrumental here.

A child can understand what I expressed tonight and earlier at the previous time when we were gathered here and I answered specific questions dealing with your community. I now mean specifically what I said about creativity -- that the creative, free-flowing process can flourish only when the tedious groundwork is done, and that freely choosing to do so (not in obedience, compelled by authority, with hidden resentments and rebellion) is in itself a great satisfaction and gratification that soon annuls whatever tediousness may initially have existed. These principles are not theories. They will soon become apparent when they are being taught.

So, with this approach, my dearest friends, it will become possible to make inroads into the creativity of the soul, of the higher self of each child. And very consciously and deliberately avenues will create themselves from within where the child's higher self will express itself, to the immense joy of the child and of his surroundings.

The process of communication is of course of major importance. We are talking here also about communication on two levels: on the conscious level of expressed words, of explanation, of the highest caliber input which is true teaching; and also on the level of awareness, feeling, and inner consciousness that may not necessarily be expressed in so many words. On both these levels, there exists a great need for improvement in the educational system. As a child wants to hear, listen, and learn (when he asks questions), so does he want to be listened to. He has a great need for that and desires to express himself. Not enough leeway is given to this, and too often his self-expression is curtailed on the simplest of levels. Encouragement to communicate his feelings, thoughts, and impressions, and being responded to, receiving feedback, as you call it, is a very essential aspect of the personality's unfoldment.

This is equally important on the inner level. For a child often perceives feelings and thoughts of others that are not openly expressed, reacts to them, but is not encouraged to take these perceptions seriously. Thus he cannot learn (a) that he does not fantasize, but rather he really perceives something, (b) that sometimes his own projections may interfere with and distort the quality of his reception. If the law of communication is being taught early on these different levels, the child will become aware of their reality. And I hardly need to emphasize what an enormous difference this will make in his life, in his dealings with himself and others. He will neither discard his reactions nor take them blindly at face value. He will learn the process of investigation, of holding final determination in reserve, of probing -- all of which will come from free self-expression of his impression and a mutual exchange not only with teachers and parents but with other children too.

In regard to the interaction on various levels, I would like to mention here a new phase in your development (you who are on the path) that signifies an interim stage. This is very important for you to understand. As you become more aware of your lower self, of previously hidden levels of consciousness and attitudes, of material that you never wanted to admit to yourself, you automatically become aware of the lower self, of the hidden material of others. As you can accept your lower self without being devastated and totally rejected, holding your inner balance and

knowing of your fundamental divine nature, so will your awareness of the lower self of others not devastate or annihilate you or make you hate and judge them. Before, when you were still battling against part of yourself, whatever awareness you had of others' negativities filled you with anxiety and discomfort. It threatened you as your own lower self threatened you. You may have perceived some aspect but in a distorted way that created disharmony in you. In this new kind of perception, the awareness is different. There is an inner calm and certainty. Previously your perceptions may only have been partially accurate because they were tinged with your projections and with your need to see others as imperfect to relieve your own conscience. Now your perception is clear and clean. This creates an entirely different climate.

To the degree you accept yourself totally and see yourself in truth both as the lower self and the higher self while the mask begins to dissolve, your perception of the other person's lower self exists in a very different way. You are very free. You understand it without turmoil. You perceive it without being upset. You see it with a clarity that does not create hate and fear in you. In that state, you can choose when and how to communicate your perceptions, if that is appropriate, and be able to take the risk of being resented for the sake of the possible benefit to the other person and to the relationship -- or not to communicate some perceptions, if that is appropriate. In this free perception, the responsibility is truly given to the other person as to what to do with his own negative attitudes and behavior, whether this is verbally expressed or not. This "letting the other person take the responsibility" happens on a very subtle but very strong level of reality that is somehow always perceived. This seems to deviate from the topic, but if you bear with me, you will see that it is very much related to it.

When this stage is achieved, it first manifests in a sort of interim stage. You come to a point when you already perceive the other person with more clarity, without a personal stake in what you see, and therefore without personal involvement. You may already be able to choose to express or not to express your perceptions according to your intuitive inspirations and truly to follow them well. At this point, a tremendous rage, anger, and hostility is created in the other person by your very freedom in seeing his hidden material. He senses this even when you do not express your perceptions. The lower self is infuriated. The conscious personality may be completely unaware of what is taking place here on the subliminal level of interchange and may create a case, a reason for this rage. At this point you may not understand at all why you are met with such virulent hatred. It is as though the other person cannot bear the clarity of your knowledge and wants to annihilate you and it. You have to go through this stage, for it represents a learning stage. It represents a doorway to a new stage again. This is the interim stage. You are not where you were. You see clearly without being personally upset and injured by what you see, without a stake in seeing it, and without distortion. But your seeing creates intense rage and intense attacks from those who are as yet defending the aspect you see and have no intention of facing it, admitting it, and changing it.

This may even apply to unseen entities, not in the body, who are very deeply involved in their darkness and who are struggling for their supremacy. They want to use all the ammunition they can muster against the clarity of the light that streams forth from you. Only when you understand and build further will the light become so strong that these reactions cannot even create a scratch in you. For the light will blind them and keep them away even when they reach out with tentacles of hatred.

This principle is extremely important to understand for those who are in the growing state of penetrating the encrustation of the mask and dissolving it and the lower self. For their relationship

to the world becomes altered. It no longer functions on the level of mutual pretense nor of mutual projections and accusations that are needed in order not to face the lower self. If the child grows up with a clear understanding of these principles, you give it an enormous protection. For without this understanding there would be confusion, fear, and vulnerability that could create a new defense. So the spiritual principles of the interaction of the inner levels is of utmost importance to comprehend for all growing human beings, whether they start on the path as adults or begin it in childhood in a new educational system. The new age person will learn these basic principles of human interaction, of the existence of the various levels of the human soul. They have to be understood just as the basics of language, of mathematics, of any topic need to be understood. But the basic laws of life are even more important.

This is what I once referred to as "life learning" when I spoke to the children at your Center. This "life learning" will encompass at least 50 percent of the curriculum. It will be the most fascinating study and will influence and alter the teaching approach of all other topics that every child is learning in school today and that adolescents learn in higher schooling. This all-encompassing knowledge of life, self, and the universe will be a very new approach of the growing child to the universe in which he lives, moves, and creates. All other, ordinary learning will then not only be easier but will have a new flavor so that the discipline necessary for it will, in most instances, be truly a self-chosen one.

New age schools will be infiltrated energetically with a new consciousness and a new awareness: the new consciousness and awareness that experiences school as the most exciting adventure imaginable. It is where life unfolds, where keys of understanding are handed to the child. Children will experience school as a privilege they look forward to even though learning also includes at times hard work and the momentary relinquishing of an immediate pleasure. The child will rejoice in discovering all the things he or she always wanted to know when it can be found out how things are really working. This will be a thrill if those who create schools, educational systems, and curricula will participate in the new consciousness.

This vision, my friends, should be cultivated by you even if you cannot as yet institute it completely. You can begin to institute it in your own consciousness, and then those who teach, through their awareness of the vision, can little by little bring out what they have to give in this new way. The time will be not so far away when you will create your own school even though there may not be too many children to begin with. But it will come and it will be an experiment that will reach out into the world and will create a completely new approach to life. All the questions I answered in our last meeting about the various committees that have formed in your Center dealing with all the necessary concerns and aspects of creating a new culture will also spread into the world and find more and more receptivity in those who are spiritually ready and thirsty for this approach. The new kind of politics, science, economics, sociology, art -- everything that is part and parcel of living in a civilized world -- will be infiltrated with this new approach just as the healing arts and education will be. Man's knowledge of the inner reality that comes as a result of following his own path must give man an entirely different outlook, approach, and motivation in whatever he is doing. A politician who is grounded in these principles must perforce develop a different approach to world government and political ideas than what the ordinary politician has now. He comes from an old age school system and is surrounded by the educational approach and the consciousness which still exists. This old approach is based mainly on appearance, on superficial, dualistic, and ego-oriented

ways. The same applies of course to every other area of life -- the artist will create differently, the economist will solve his problems from a different vantage point, and so on and so forth.

Even you who have started this path -- at least most of you -- as adults have already a very different approach to all of life and its areas of activity in the community of mankind. You can imagine that children who grow up in a system of education such as I describe here will affect the world very differently. You can imagine how much stronger truth will flow, how much more forcefully from a very different area from within the person. Truly, laws of God, laws of the divine world in a flowing, flexible, ever changing way will pour forth into your world and indeed create a new world.

May this lecture again be a foundation stone for another new building, in a spiritual sense, and later even in a material sense. And may it also help you in your innermost being to take in this new seed once again, even though it is not immediately and directly applicable to you. But it will help you personally in a different sense. When you see that the path you are treading, the way you are going into your innermost self is the key to a new approach to life that has much farther reaching consequences in the evolution than you may believe; you may perhaps also perceive that there is a vast plan behind your individual path that transcends your personal fate, your personal problems, which may have been the initial motivations to come here as far as your conscious awareness was concerned. It now evolves that your inner being knew more and had a vaster plan in mind. This will bring light, encouragement, and strength to you wherever you are now on your path. You are all blessed, my very beloved dearest ones. Be in peace, be in joy, be in the beauty that unfolds itself forever more in your life.

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